TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2022
6:00 PM

BUDGET HEARING & AGENDA HEARING

Note: October 25, 2022 Published Advertisement

Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw called the meeting to order 6:03. Town Administrator Milie provided a summary of the budget. He explained some changes in the revenue streams that were temporary ARPA funding. He explained the T-SPLOST failed so any infrastructure planned under this approval now will be under SPLOST Funding. There was a new revenue line item for the festivals which includes sponsorships, for $90,000. It was expected $75,000 will be from sponsorship. A new revenue fund was added for the traffic camera funding. Depending on the incoming funding from the traffic camera there may be a shift in funding to allow hiring another officer. The funding from the camera must be used for Police equipment. The $100,000 was from budget savings from each department to go to reserve for capital purchases later. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked if the valve project would be internally or contractually done. Public Works Manager Crosby stated it would be a contract due to proprietary nature of the equipment. Council Member Drohan asked about billing changes that were implemented the beginning the year. These billing changes may show $100,000 to $180,000 saved. Those savings can be put to infrastructure cost because we will not be purchasing the higher rate water. Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw states we need to see what the numbers are in November and December.

Council Member Drohan spoke on the Thunderbolt Development Resource Utilization Project. This project is to inform Council and Planning & Zoning of water and sewer availability and infrastructure needed. The raw data has been compiled and is now being analyzed.

There were no more questions on the budget. Mayor Pro-tem closed the public hearing 6:32 pm

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Pro-tem called the regular business meeting to order at 6:32 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those in attendance were Mayor Pro-tem David Crenshaw and Council Members: Bethany Skipper-Greer, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan, James Lavin and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Utilities/Accts. Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman and Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby.

Mayor Dana Williams was not in attendance.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked for a motion to approve adding the proclamation for the Chatham County Retired Teachers at the end of the agenda. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the additional proclamation with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.** Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting:**
Minutes of October 12, 2022

Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked for a motion to approve the October 12, 2022 meeting minutes. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentations:**

a) Finance Report:

Shannon Brett, Holland Bromley, Barnhill &Brett, provided a financial update. Ms. Brett explained she, Town Administrator and Council Member Crenshaw were meeting with the Bank to make sure the accounts are in the best possible position. October revenues are 5.6 million which are in line with the time of the year. Expenses are at 5.1 million. The town has used 72% of the budget. Ms. Brett explained they have begun the year end task: SPLOST ad, fire subscription, immigration, and payroll for year end. Council Member Drohan asked about the revenue reserve for W & S interest. Town Administrator Milie stated it is very low. Council Member Drohan asked if there is any value in having a rainy-day fund. Mayor Pro-temp Crenshaw stated GMA suggests six months of reserves. The law requires 30%. Ms. Brett stated the way it is handled now is the reasonable way to do it. Ward asked if they are shopping around. Milie reached out to others and they were a few he liked but United is in our jurisdiction and would make it easier to do business with them. Crenshaw stated we should shop around but leave it with United.

6. **Consent Agenda:**

Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked to pull a and c to the debate agenda and asked for a motion to approve the outdoor event permit for Wesley Oak Methodist Church. Council Member Ward made motion to approve with a second by Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.

a) Approval of the Thunderbolt Museum Lease. Staff Recommends Approval.

Town Administrator Milie recapped the concern Thunderbolt Museum had with paying the $500. There was a follow up with Mayor Williams and Anna Maria Thomas to discuss options for the museum and the museum agrees to the $500 rental cost. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to approve with a second from Council Member Ward.** Council Member Drohan asked if the lease has an out for the museum. Town Administrator Milie stated there is an out and so does the Town. Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw called for a vote. **The motion passed unanimously.**

b) Formal Approval of the Wesley Oak Methodist Church Outdoor Event held October 29, 2022. This Event Was Approved by Email but it Needs to be Approved Formally by Council.

c) Approval of the Cost Recovery Agreement and Resolution for Fire Department. This Agreement Allows a Billing to Insurance Companies Only and Only for Non-County Residents. The Billing is handled by a Third Party. This Agreement is Being Used Around the County. The Resolution Allows for this Billing to be Implemented. Staff Recommends Approval.

Town Administrator Milie explained this is for cost recovery for accidents and other events. This is billed to the insurance company. It will not pertain to town residents. Only services performed by Thunderbolt Fire will be charged. This company is the same one being used regionally. This will be a new revenue stream. The company fees are 40% of the bill. Estimated revenue for a small town about $10,000. Council Member Lavin asked about the billing process. Town Administrator Milie provided an example. Council Member Lavin wanted to know the liability to the town. Town Administrator Milie stated there is no additional cost. The Fire Department will need to adjust their current reporting process. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked Fire Chief Bateman if he felt comfortable with the changes. Chief explained several of the part timers are already using this company and are comfortable with the reporting process. Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked about charging by Federal numbers. Chief Bateman explains it is based on the federal average of what is used and time spent. Council Member Ward asked about double billing. Chief Bateman stated no issue. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion was unanimously approved.**

7. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Discussion of a One Dollar Increase in Sanitation Cost.

Town Administrator Milie explained the sanitation cost for 2023 was not covered by the monthly fees. There is no reserve in sanitation, so we do not make any money. Atlantic Waste went up this year and the monthly fee stayed the same and was absorbed by the Town. There are two options for the town. Option 1: raise the 1 dollar to pay for the actual cost of sanitation. Option 2 the Town absorbs the rate increase. Council Member Ward asked if businesses pay more than residential. Utilities Manager Spaulding explained businesses have an option to hire someone or pay the Town. Council Member Drohan stated the infrastructure cost is built in. There is no inherent cost. I think there should be a flat rate to pay for itself. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked it the resident or business has more than one can is there an addition cost per can. Town Administrator Milie explained they must pay for additional cans. He also stated he is working with Atlantic Waste on options to reduce recycling pick up to every other week. Council Member Drohan stated most citizens do not have full cans in a week. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to increase the sanitation fee by $1. Council Member Skipper-Greer seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police

Chief Clayton praised our officer who is attached to the DEA Office. They have been working on a case for 6 years and to date 49 people have been indicted. The DEA office has placed him over the major case division.

Chief Clayton stated there have been 376 violations for the school camara from the month it went live.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Chief Bateman stated the training room completion is down to the flooring. This should take three to five weeks. Bay heaters are in place. Council Member Lavin pointed out Fire's work on the clean and tidy days. Chief Bateman stated they are insuring every home has working smoke detectors. They have teamed up with the Red Cross to insure installation of smoke detectors in the area.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Public Works Manager Crosby stated four fire hydrants have been replaced. In December the valve on Shell Rd will be installed. Public Works Manager told Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw the chlorides look good.

9. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie reported the Heating and Air on Police Department side has been fixed. The LMIG has been expanded to include Tuberson. Currently working on writing a grant, through GA Forestry, for a tree grant to cover the cost of the tree inventory and have added looking at the tree canopy.

10. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

11. **Mayor and Council –**

a) TDRUP Ad hoc Committee Council Member Drohan – spoke during public hearing at the beginning of the meeting.

Mayor Pro-tem presented a proclamation to the Chatham Retired Educators Association President, Mrs. Annette Mitchell.

Mayor Pro-tem Crenshaw asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously**.

12. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 7:28 pm.

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion